

UI/UX Design with Figma - Hour 6: Design Systems & Styles

Hour 6: Design Systems & Styles in Figma (2 Academic Hours)

- Goal: Teach students how to build scalable and consistent UI designs using styles, tokens, and design systems in Figma.

1. What is a Design System?

- Definition: A Design System is a collection of reusable components and rules for creating consistent UI.
- Why use one?
 - - Faster design and development.
 - - Maintains visual consistency.
 - - Scales well across teams and projects.
- Example: Google Material Design, Apple HIG.

2. Styles in Figma: Reusability & Consistency

- Text Styles:
 - - Heading 1, Heading 2, Paragraph, Small Text.
 - - Font family, weight, size, line height, spacing.
- How to create:
 - - Select text, define style, click 'Style' + button, name it.
- Color Styles:
 - - Categories: Primary, Secondary, Background, Text.
 - - Helpful for dark/light modes.
- How to create:
 - - Select object -> Fill -> Add color -> Click 'Style' +.
- Icon Sets:
 - - Use icon libraries (Feather, Material Icons).
 - - Import SVGs, make components, keep uniform size.
 - - Organize icons in frames or a dedicated page.

3. Atomic Design Methodology

- Invented by Brad Frost - breaks UI into 5 levels:
 - 1. Atoms - basic UI elements like buttons, inputs.
 - 2. Molecules - groups like label + input.
 - 3. Organisms - sections like navbars.
 - 4. Templates - page-level layouts.
 - 5. Pages - filled-out final UI with real data.
- Benefit: Build from small to large UI consistently.

4. Structure of a Basic Design System

- Pages to include in Figma:
 - - Typography
 - - Color Palette
 - - Components (buttons, inputs, cards)
 - - Icon Set
 - - Grid & Layout System
- Naming conventions:
 - - text/heading/h1, color/primary, button/primary/default
- Tip: Use Figma Team Library to publish reusable styles (optional).

5. Task: Set Up a Basic Design System

- Students will create:
 - - Typography: H1 (36px), H2 (24px), Paragraph (16px)
 - - Color Palette: Primary, Secondary, Text, Background
 - - 3 Button Components: Primary, Secondary, Ghost
 - - 2 Icons: Add and convert to components (e.g. home, settings)
 - Bonus: Apply styles in a simple card or layout section.

6. Review & Sharing

- - Students present their design systems.
- - Instructor gives feedback on naming, consistency, structure.
- - Optionally: export and share as a design library file.